

A Hearts Vengeance

Intro Scene

Property Of:
The Volto Corporation

The wind bites into my skin and I can hardly feel my fingers anymore. Everything just looks the same; snow as far as the eye can see, long dark trees that stretch to the heavens, with no other movement but the wind that shakes their branches.

Except us.

That won't last long.

The howl of the creatures mix with the blistering wind forming a screeching melody. I can't seem to figure out where exactly the melodic cacophony is coming from, but it can't be far from us. They're faster than us -bigger; stronger.

The only advantage we have is our size. We might be able to burrow in the snow. Hide until they have lost interest. Would that even help?

They have our scent. Owain always told us they could smell fear, that they prefer the fear of children over any other. I hope that this time he's wrong, otherwise our chances have gone from zero to negative.

I think we never really had any chance to begin with. I can't move anymore.

I collapse onto my knees, sinking deeper into the snow. I see my breath come out in short pants. Even as sweat runs down my brow I fear I'm going to turn into ice. I try to stand up again but my legs feel like lead.

I want to go home.

The hand I was holding slips out of my grasp and moves to my shoulder, shaking me lightly. I feel them on my face now, forcing me to look up. I see the tear-streaked face of Eri. His mouth moves but I can't hear a single word he's saying.

I use his arms to attempt to lift myself up, but I just seem to sink further into the snow. I don't know how much longer we can last; how further we can run before they catch us.

I seem to be the only one plagued by these thoughts, because Eri pulls me up and puts my arm around his shoulder to drag me along. He doesn't want to give up. He'll keep on going until his body screams in agony.

He would probably ignore it and keep going. I'm going to get us killed. We are barely moving, they are going to catch us.

["You need to go."]

"You need to get as far as you can, without me."

I try to pull my arm away but he just grips me tighter, tugging me closer to his side.

"Please Eri, I can distract them, then at least one of us-"

"I'm not leaving you!"

His yell echoes loudly against the trees, drowning out the wind for a moment. His anger only seems to last for a few seconds before fresh tears run down his cheeks.

"I'm not losing anyone else. I'm not losing you."

His sobs affect his entire body, making him shake and gasp for air. I always hated seeing him like this.

I try to comfort him but a screeching laugh makes my entire body freeze.

[[Try to at least move my legs.]]

With the last bit of strength I try to move my legs even as my body screams at me to stop. I sink deeper into the snow. It doesn't seem to matter to Erlan: he just keeps moving forward.

"There we go, just keep on moving we'll be fine I promise."

He pulls me up and drags me along the snow. If he feels any strain, he doesn't show it, just simply moving forward as if there isn't a demon that is about to kill us.

I try to move my legs forward but a screeching laugh makes my entire body freeze.

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We both turn around, clinging closer to one another. One of them found us.

It's smaller than most but its teeth are nothing to scoff at. It has multiple eyes coating the boney skin. Most of the flesh is gone or peeling off, revealing its pitch black bones.

It must have died of starvation.

It doesn't move, simply watching us with a grin on its face.

Neither of us move. I don't think we even breathe. One small noise might set it off. It might not matter either way. It could be toying with us, or worse, waiting for orders.

Erlan's mother told us that demons don't eat us for nourishment, they either do it under orders, or purely for pleasure. Either we are its plaything or its target. Both mean death.

It stands on its hind legs, towering over us, its grin never leaving its face. Its claws are soaked in blood and it has a long slash running down its stomach. It's not bleeding. It doesn't even look like it's in pain.

It's unnerving. It's wrong.

It slowly moves closer, its grin becomes even larger, reaching the corners of its malnourished face. The sound of its flesh tearing off its bones seems louder than the wind.

It crouches back down, placing one limb in the snow to keep itself steady. It wants to pounce at us. It's going to kill us with a grin on its face.

All I see is its maw opening before Erlan pushes me into the snow, using his body to shield me. I grip onto him, moving my hands to his head to try to protect him. I don't feel the scream that escapes my throat.

I don't want to lose him.

I don't want to die.

A painful scream fills the air following the sound of piercing flesh. I can taste the bile burning my throat as I slowly open my eyes.

I almost throw up with relief when I see him. His breathing is erratic, his hold on me is painfully tight, but he's alive. I begin to pat him down, seeing if there's any wounds, but he's unharmed. The scream wasn't his .

Erlan's eyes are tightly shut, but as the seconds pass he notices that he's not feeling any pain. He begins to slowly open them. He checks me first for any injuries, then proceeds to check himself. Confusion is plainly written on his face.

He must have also thought the scream was his. He still uses his body as a shield but slightly shuffles so I can see over his shoulder and he himself can look ahead. The demon is hurt and the culprit is standing in front of us.

Owain.